

Part 6: Take back control

The point at which access to and responsibility for your salary is handed back to you is discretionary. You need to ask yourself: Am I ready mentally? And am I at the point where I need to prove my savings record to the bank?

Ready or not?

Readiness for me was not feeling frustration and yearning when I was unable to buy whatever I wanted, which tormented me in the early months of saving. It was walking past my favourite stores and feeling nothing – those thoughts had subsided after about six months on the savings plan. And it was having pocket money consistently left over, and in increasing sums, as my rationing became second nature. To get to that point took me about 18 months.

Cold hard evidence

Your bank will want to know you are a reliable candidate for a loan. Each bank will have its own criteria, influenced in part by whether you are an existing customer of theirs (more details on this in Step 3, 'How to Read the Market like a Pro'). It is never too early to ask your bank for an outline of what they need and expect, for when the time comes to apply for a mortgage. It's motivating to have that blueprint, and to think and look ahead.